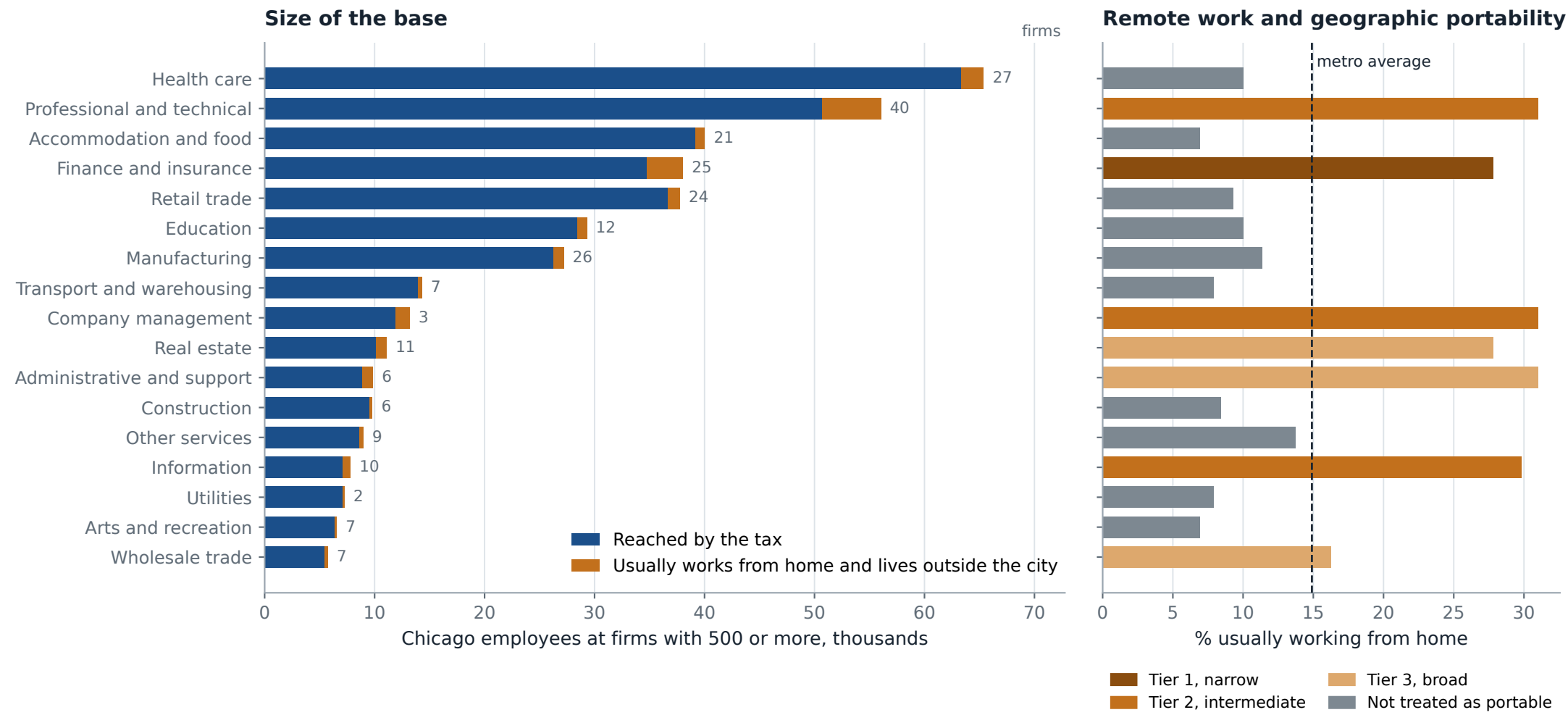


Most of the tax base sits in sectors not treated as portable, but not all of it

Firms with 500 or more Chicago employees in 2025: 243 firms, 388,336 employees, of which 10% to 37% sit in portable sectors depending on where the line is drawn



Firms are corporate parents (Employer's Expense Tax Ruling #2). Work-from-home rates are American Community Survey 2024 one-year estimates for the Chicago metropolitan area, by industry group, applied to each firm's sector. Survey industry groups are broader than the sectors shown, so administrative services share a rate with professional services, real estate with finance, and education with health care.

Portability tiers are analyst-defined and nested, and are an assumption of the analysis rather than a finding: Tier 1 is finance and insurance; Tier 2 adds information, professional and technical services and management of companies; Tier 3 adds real estate, administrative and support services and wholesale trade. The dashed line is the metro all-industry rate of 14.9%, shown so the reader can see which sectors a purely rate-based rule would select.

The survey counts only people who usually work from home, so hybrid employees who commute most days count as commuters; this is therefore a lower bound on remote work. Employees who work from home inside Chicago are still working in Chicago, so only those living elsewhere are shown in orange (69.3% of Chicago jobs are held by city residents).

Sources: Data Axle (Infogroup) 2025 business file; ACS tables B08126, B08008 and B08604.